

Topic 7: Fragile environments and climate change

What students need to learn

Key ideas	Detailed content
7.1 Fragile environments are under threat from desertification, deforestation and global climate change	a) Distributions and characteristics of the world's fragile environments. (1) b) Causes of desertification (drought, population pressure, fuel supply, overgrazing, migration) and deforestation (commercial timber extraction, agriculture, mining, transport; settlement and HEP (hydroelectric power). (2) and (3) c) Causes of natural climate change (Milankovitch cycles, solar variation and volcanism) and how human activities (industry, transport, energy, and farming) can cause the enhanced greenhouse effect. (4)